

Gautam Velpula

Head of Enterprise Architecture

Technology Strategy • Platform Modernization • Business-Aligned IT Investment

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Executive Summary

Enterprise architecture leader with 15+ years of experience setting architectural direction, defining future-state roadmaps, and ensuring technology investments drive measurable business outcomes. Currently serving as the single architectural authority for a multi-brand enterprise, leading technology modernization, portfolio rationalization, and governance across business, solution, and technical architecture disciplines. Deep experience connecting IT investment decisions to business economics—revenue growth, cost optimization, and risk reduction. Combines strong business and financial literacy with broad technology knowledge across cloud, APIs, microservices, event-driven architectures, and data platforms. Proven ability to position EA as a strategic enabler of business strategy while balancing long-term architectural direction with near-term delivery needs.

Professional Experience

GoTo Foods LLC

2021 – Present

Sr Director, Enterprise Architecture

- Built and led the enterprise architecture function from the ground up, defining the EA charter, service portfolio, and value proposition to meet evolving business and IT needs across a multi-brand restaurant organization.
- Established EA governance, decision rights, and operating model in partnership with IT leadership, balancing agility with risk and compliance.
- Positioned EA as a strategic enabler of business strategy—securing stakeholder buy-in by communicating EA services, expectations, and outcomes to executive leadership.
- Led comprehensive current-state assessments and defined target-state architecture roadmaps across 7 brands, identifying gaps, risks, and prioritized investments.
- Drove technology portfolio rationalization and technical-debt reduction, defining a modernization implementation plan that consolidated 7 independent brand platforms into a unified, API-led architecture.
- Established architecture principles, standards, patterns, and guardrails—enabling effective decisions and reuse through communities of practice and cross-functional partnership.
- Connected technology investments to business economics: framed architecture decisions in terms of revenue impact, cost reduction, and risk mitigation using operating-model and financial analysis.
- Led cross-functional mapping of business capabilities and value streams, identifying improvement opportunities and recommending solution options across digital, payments, marketing technology, and data.
- Drove platform modernization from monolithic legacy systems to microservices and event-driven architecture, standardizing APIs, service contracts, and integration patterns.
- Advised on and led adoption of emerging technologies including **generative AI**—defining architectural patterns, guardrails, and governance for safe, scalable enterprise usage.
- Reduced time-to-market by approximately 40% and improved system uptime by approximately 30% through modernization and architectural consolidation.
- Built and developed a team of principal and lead architects, raising the technical bar and growing leadership bench strength through mentoring and succession planning.

Slalom Consulting
Senior Delivery Principal

2018 – 2021

- Served as senior architecture and delivery advisor for multi-million-dollar IT strategy, platform modernization, and digital transformation engagements for Fortune 500 clients.
- Conducted enterprise-scale current-state assessments and defined target-state architecture roadmaps, including a multi-year modernization plan for one of the largest eCommerce companies in the U.S.
- Led a major cloud migration from on-premises and AWS to GCP, defining the future-state architecture and migration sequencing for a leading technology provider.
- Connected technology investment recommendations to business outcomes—framing trade-offs across cost, risk, and time-to-value for executive stakeholders.
- Directed cross-functional teams spanning architecture, engineering, product, and design across multi-year engagements.
- Implemented scaled Agile and DevOps practices, increasing deployment frequency by approximately 30% and reducing lead time by approximately 25%.
- Achieved approximately 95% client satisfaction through practical, actionable architecture guidance integrated into delivery.

Jacada (acquired by Uniphore)
Director, Professional Services

2014 – 2018

- Owned global professional services delivery for enterprise customers, leading large-scale solution architecture and implementation programs for Fortune 500 clients.
- Served as the senior-most technical and architectural leader within services, providing solution design guidance, integration architecture, and escalation support across complex, multi-tier environments.
- Led cross-functional mapping of customer business processes and capabilities to define solution architecture and implementation approach.
- Acted as a trusted advisor to C-level stakeholders, translating between business and technical audiences to drive alignment and adoption.
- Built and scaled a global services organization through recruiting, standardized practices, and change leadership.

Technology & Architecture Expertise

Architecture Disciplines: Business architecture, solution/technical architecture, data/information architecture, integration architecture

Cloud & Platform: Microsoft Azure (AKS, Front Door, API Management, Functions), Google Cloud Platform, SaaS/PaaS

Architecture Patterns: Microservices, event-driven architecture, API-led integration, composable architecture

Data & Analytics: Cosmos DB, Databricks, Event Hub, Service Bus, CDP, analytics platforms

Emerging Technology: Generative AI, LLM integration, agentic AI, intelligent automation

Frameworks & Practices: TOGAF (familiarity), scaled Agile/Lean, DevOps, CI/CD, SDLC, IT service management

Core Strengths

EA Function Leadership & Governance • Technology Modernization & Portfolio Rationalization • Business Capability Mapping • IT Investment & Business Economics • Executive Stakeholder Management • Architecture Standards & Guardrails • Change Leadership • Team Building & Mentorship

Education

Master of Science in Information Technology

2007 – 2009

George Mason University, Fairfax, VA

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science

2002 – 2006

Osmania University, Hyderabad, India